

ETC

Meet some model moms Sunday at Raptor Center

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Did you know that raptors are among the few species that divide parenting duties between moms and dads?

Did you know that female raptors exhibit a rare trait in the animal kingdom? (They're actually bigger than the males.)

These are some of the facts you'll learn when the Carolina Raptor Center celebrates Mother's Day in a fine, feathered way.

On Sunday, the center will offer its own ode to mothers and their children.

Families are invited to take a special guided tour in which they'll be introduced to the bird families living at the center, with an emphasis placed on the mother's role.

The center has some prolific inhabitants, like the two owls who produce offspring without fail every year. Then there's the love triangle between Queen Charlotte and King Raleigh — a happy eagle

couple until a younger female named Haley was recently brought to the center and caught the King's eye. The Queen is not amused.

Although there are lots of baby raptors at the center, mothers are very protective and hide them from the public. It will be a treat if you spot a little one during the tour.

Mother's Day tours will be 11:30 a.m. and 1 p.m. at the center, in Latta Plantation Park on Sample Road in Huntersville (off

Beatties Ford Road). Admission is \$4 for adults, \$2 for students and senior citizens, free for members and for children 4 and younger.

For details, call the center at 875-6521.